

DECEMBER for TOURISM

December is a prime month for tourism, offering a diverse range of experiences from festive winter wonderlands to warm tropical escapes, catering to various traveler preferences. This month is characterized by holiday celebrations, peak travel seasons in certain regions, and opportunities for both snowy adventures and sunny getaways. For travelers looking to escape the cold, December offers numerous warm-weather destinations like Sri Lanka.

Many destinations transform into magical winter landscapes, ideal for those seeking a traditional holiday experience, Christmas vibes with twinkling lights, mulled wine, and carolers. Internationally, countries like Switzerland and Finland are renowned for their winter charm in December. Switzerland boasts stunning snowy landscapes, world-class skiing in the Alps. Finland is a true winter wonderland and Germany is famous for its traditional Christmas markets. The United Kingdom also comes alive with Christmas markets, lights, and seasonal events. Hawaii, is a tropical paradise with golden sands and warm waters, perfect for a sun-soaked getaway. Australia experiences summer in December. New Zealand also enjoys summer, offering excellent conditions for hiking, water activities, and wildlife viewing. Mexico provides warm weather for enjoying beaches. Costa Rica marks the beginning of its dry season in December, making it an opportune time to explore rainforests, wildlife, and beaches. Thailand offers pleasantly warm temperatures, ideal for beaches and outdoor activities, with festive decorations in cities like Bangkok.

Sri Lanka in December 2025 offers a vibrant mix of cultural experiences, wildlife encounters, and beach relaxation, making it a prime destination for tourists. December is a prime month for tourism, offering a diverse range of experiences, catering to various traveler preferences. The month marks the peak of the tourist season in the southern parts of the island, characterized by pleasant weather conditions including popular beach areas, entering its dry season, providing ideal conditions for tourism. Due to favorable weather in key tourist areas and winter vacations in the Northern Hemisphere, December is a busy month, leading to increased crowds.

Tourists visiting Sri Lanka in December 2025 can look forward to a diverse range of activities:

Beach Activities: The southern coast offers prime beach conditions for swimming, surfing, and relaxation.

Trekking and Nature: The hill country, including Adam's Peak, Ella Rock, and Horton Plains, offers pleasant trekking opportunities in December due to cooler, greener conditions. The pilgrimage season for Adam's Peak traditionally begins on the full moon in December [4]. Tea plantation areas like Ceylon and Nuwara Eliya are also recommended for visits, offering scenic beauty and a glimpse into Sri Lanka's tea industry [2].

Christmas festivities are celebrated, particularly in Colombo and Negombo, with hotels hosting special events [1] [4]. Colombo comes alive with concerts and parties for New Year's Eve [2].

Wellness: Sri Lanka is a renowned destination for Ayurvedic treatments and massages, offering detoxification and relaxation

Some Destination Management Companies (DMC) are offering "5 Days Tour Packages" starting from US\$352. "Discover Sri Lanka Beauty" from US\$1,320. "Economy 08 Days [Highlights of Sri Lanka in Winter]" start from US\$1,079, and longer, more luxurious options like "Hello Sri Lanka: 11 Days of Wonder - Semi-Luxury" start from US\$1,618.



Festive Cheer: **Pre-Christmas Celebrations** **at Sri Lanka's Premier** **Tourist Hotels**

Christmas celebrations at hotels can really bring the festive spirit to life. Here's a list of some popular hotels in Colombo, Kandy, and other areas of Sri Lanka that typically host events like Christmas cake mixing and tree lighting ceremonies. Let's dive into the details!

Hilton Colombo known for its lavish Christmas cake mixing event and Christmas Tree lighting on Nov.28. Cinnamon Grand Colombo and Cinnamon Lakeside offered a festive atmosphere with cake mixing sessions and various Christmas-themed dining experiences. Taj Samudra Colombo hosted traditional Christmas celebrations and the tree lighting is on Nov.27. Shangri-La Colombo and Kingsbury Colombo are both renowned for their splendid Christmas celebrations. Here's a closer look at what these hotels, along with ICT and other notable hotels in Colombo, typically offered during the festive season:

Shangri-La often hosts a delightful cake mixing event where guests participate while making it a fun and interactive experience. The hotel usually features a grand tree lighting ceremony, accompanied by festive music and decorations. They offer special Christmas menus in their restaurants, focusing on holiday favorites. Kingsbury Colombo is known for its vibrant Christmas celebrations, including cake mixing sessions where guests can join in the fun. The hotel organizes a festive tree lighting event, often featuring live music and entertainment. Their restaurants typically offer a special festive buffet complete with traditional Christmas dishes. Mövenpick Hotel Colombo hosts festive events, including cake mixing and special dining experiences throughout the Christmas season. Christmas Cake Mixing at ITC Ratnadipa where the management, staff and guests participated in the traditional preparation of Christmas cake. It's a fun way to kick off the festive season, and participants enjoyed the delicious aromas of spices and dried fruits. ITC Ratnadeepa Tree Lighting Ceremony is on Nov. 28. The hotel usually hosts a festive tree lighting ceremony, creating a beautiful and festive atmosphere including music, entertainment, and a gathering of guests to celebrate the holiday spirit. Throughout December, ITC Ratnadipa often features special Christmas menus in its restaurants. Guests can enjoy a variety of traditional Christmas dishes and festive treats, making dining a delightful experience. These celebrations offer a wonderful opportunity for guests to immerse themselves in the holiday spirit while enjoying the luxurious hospitality of ITC Ratnadipa. These hotels truly embrace the holiday spirit and provide wonderful experiences for both locals and tourists.

Cinnamon Citadel Kandy celebrated with cake mixing activities and a beautiful Christmas display overlooking the river. Amaya Hills Kandy known for its scenic views and Christmas events including tree lighting and festive dinners. Anantara Peace Haven Tangalle Resort hosted festive celebrations on the beach, including tree lighting and special dining experiences. These hotels not only provide festive activities but also creates a warm holiday atmosphere for guests.